Willard Robinson

North Carolina State University | wmrobin3@ncsu.edu | 828-620-0798 | WMRobin.github.io

Education

North Carolina State University, Ph.D. Economics — 2027 (expected)
Committee: Spencer Banzhaf (advisor), Erin Sills, Roger von Haefen, Zhenxuan Wang

Montana State University, M.S. Applied Economics — 2022

Appalachian State University, B.A. Economics *(summa cum laude)* — 2020
Minor: Mathematics

Research fields

Fields: Environmental and natural resource economics, environmental markets, nonmarket valuation

Working papers

Asymmetric Information and Costly Participation in Voluntary Conservation Markets (**Job market paper**) [PDF]

Adoption Costs for Offsets: Evidence from California [PDF]

- Under review
- First place, *William D. Toussaint Best Paper Award*, NC State Economics Department

Works in progress

Recreation Welfare Effects of Climate-Driven Species Redistribution

Impacts of Centralized Budget Policy on National Parks: An analysis of the Federal Land Recreation Enhancement Act

The Value of Shoreline Recreational Fishing Across Time and Space: An internal meta-regression approach (with Sasha Naumenko, Colton Leach, and Roger von Haefen)

Stability in Centralized College Major Assignment (with Umut Dur)

Research experience

CEnREP graduate research assistant for Prof. Spencer Banzhaf — Jan. 2024–present

- "*Making Markets Work*"
- "*The Market for Environmental Offsets*"

Graduate research assistant for Prof. Umut Dur — Jan. 2025–Jan. 2026

- *"Stability in Centralized College Major Assignment"*

Graduate research assistant for Prof. Nick Hagerty — Aug. 2020–May 2022

- *"Anticipatory Effects of Regulating the Commons"* with Ellen Bruno (2025), Journal of Environmental Economics and Management, vol. 132: 103183

Research assistant for Prof. John Whitehead — Jun. 2019–May 2020

- Nonmarket valuation

Research assistant for Prof. Brock Stoddard — Jun. 2019–May 2020

- Experimental economics

Teaching experience

U. = Undergraduate course, *Ph.D.* = Doctorate course

Instructor

NC State University

ARE 336 (*U.*): *Introduction to Environmental and Resource Economics* — Fall '25

Montana State University

ECNS 202 (*U.*): *Principles of Macroeconomics* — Fall '21, Spring '22

Graduate teaching assistant

NC State University

ARE 336 (*U.*): *Introduction to Environmental and Resource Economics* — Fall '23, Spring '25, Fall '26

ARE 301 (*U.*): *Intermediate Microeconomics* — Fall '26

ECG 702 (*Ph.D.*): *Microeconomic Theory II* — Spring '24

EC 201 (*U.*): *Principles of Microeconomics* — Fall '22, Spring '22, Fall '23

Head TA in Fall '23

Montana State University

ECNS 202 (*U.*): *Principles of Macroeconomics* — Summer '21, Summer '22

ECNS 403R (*U.*): *(Honors) Introductory Econometrics* — Fall '20

Seminars and conference presentations (including scheduled*)

Asymmetric Information and Transaction Costs in Voluntary Conservation Markets (all in 2026)

Camp Resources XXXII, North Carolina State University, Triangle Theory Workshop*, AERE @ the Southern Economic Association*, Appalachian State University*, East Carolina University*

Adoption Costs for Offsets: Evidence from California

NCSU Economics Third Year Workshop (2026)

Impacts of Centralized Budget Policy on National Parks: An analysis of the Federal Land Recreation Enhancement Act

Property and Environment Research Center (2025), Appalachian Experimental and Environmental Workshop (2024)

Recreation Welfare Effects of Climate-Driven Species Redistribution

NCSU Graduate Student Seminar Series (2025)

Awards and fellowships

Andrew J. & Thelma K. Bartley Endowed Graduate Fellowship, NC State Poole College of Management — 2026

NBER travel grant — 2026

First place, Best Paper Award, NC State Department of Economics — 2026

PERC graduate summer fellowship, Property and Environment Research Center — 2025

Top student in economics, Appalachian State University — 2020

Professional activities

Referee service

AERE @ the Southern Economic Association conference, Environmental Research Letters

University service

Graduate student seminar organizer, NCSU 2025–present

Vice President, Economics Graduate Student Association, NCSU 2024–present

Membership

American Economic Association
Association of Environmental and Resource Economists
European Association of Environmental Resource Economists

Technical skills

Computing: Julia, Git, LaTeX, Matlab, R, SAS, Stata

References

Spencer Banzhaf
Professor
North Carolina State University
spencer_banzhaf@ncsu.edu

Roger von Haefen
Professor
North Carolina State University
roger_von_haefen@ncsu.edu

Zhenxuan Wang
Assistant Professor
North Carolina State University
zhenxuan.wang@ncsu.edu